

altairsim — examples

2026-07-28 · 61f9327

Machines that boot. Each directory here is self-contained: a `.toml` that describes the machine, the media it needs lying beside it, and a note saying what you will see. Copy any one of them anywhere and it still runs — a path inside a machine file resolves against **that file**, not against the directory you launched from.

```
altairsim examples/cpm/cpm22-buffered.toml    # CP/M 2.2b on an 8" floppy
altairsim examples/basic/basic4k.toml         # Altair 4K BASIC, off a 1975 cassette
altairsim examples/uio/uio.toml               # Altair 8K BASIC over ONE 88-UIO (serial +
cassette)
altairsim examples/sol/trek80.toml            # a Sol-20 at SOLOS, with TREK80 in the deck
altairsim examples/debugger/debugger.toml     # a bench for learning the symbolic debugger
altairsim examples/dazzler/kscope.toml       # a Cromemco Dazzler, drawing a kaleidoscope
altairsim examples/printing/printer.toml     # an 88-C700 printer, wired to a real host printer
```

	What it is
<code>cpm/</code>	Mike Douglas's track-buffered CP/M 2.2b v2.3 , 56K, booted by the DBL PROM from an 8" floppy. <code>A></code> in one command.
<code>basic/</code>	Altair 4K BASIC 3.1 read off a period <code>.tap</code> by the bootstrap MITS shipped, unmodified. <code>MEMORY SIZE?</code>
<code>uio/</code>	Altair 8K BASIC 3.2 over a single 88-UIO — the board that is a 6850 serial port (at 0x10) <i>and</i> an 88-ACR cassette (at 0x06) in one. The period bootstrap runs unmodified. <code>MEMORY SIZE?</code>
<code>sol/</code>	A Processor Technology Sol-20 running SOLOS 1.3, with the 1977 game TREK80 on cassette. Type <code>XE TRK80</code> .
<code>debugger/</code>	A 46-byte program with its symbols and a guided walk through the monitor's debugger: <code>SYMBOLS LOAD</code> , symbolic <code>DISASM</code> , single-step, break on a label, run.
<code>dazzler/</code>	A Cromemco Dazzler , the S-100's first color graphics card, running Li-Chen Wang's Kaleidoscope . Comes up drawing a four-way-mirrored pattern in a window; <code>ATTN</code> (Ctrl-E) breaks back to the monitor.
<code>pmmi/</code>	A PMMI MM-103 modem and a small 8080 terminal program that bridges the console to the phone line. Four control keys work the modem — <code>^D</code> DTR, <code>^S</code> the 6860 Self Test loopback, <code>^I</code> modem status, <code>^C</code> quit. <code>^D</code> then <code>^S</code> makes the card echo your keystrokes with no phone line attached; set <code>dial/answer</code> to place a real call over TCP.
<code>printing/</code>	An 88-C700 line printer , and a banner program that prints through it. The README sets up a real printer on your host — a network printer over <code>socket:</code> , or a CUPS queue over <code>printer:</code> — and a page comes out. Per-OS host setup (macOS, Linux; Windows pending).

This tree is the product, which is the reason it exists as one directory rather than as media scattered through `disks/` and `tapes/`. It is what `tools/build-package.sh` assembles, it is what `docs/manual/quick-start.md` promises, and `acceptance-examples` boots every one of these out of a scratch directory with no repository in sight — because "does it work here" and "does it work where we hand it to people" turned out to be different questions.

Nothing is duplicated. `disks/` and `tapes/` keep only what does **not** ship: the period `.ASM` listings the boards were built from, download stubs for optional images, and vendor documentation.